

Research Innovation Funding Policy — Implementation Guidelines

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Issued in 2022 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/POL/2022/037, this implementation guidelines establishes the arrangements supporting Research Innovation Funding Policy. In scope are Research, Innovation, Funding, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Overview

This document accompanies Research Innovation Funding Policy and provides operational detail for Research, Innovation. Its purpose is to help those responsible for implementation act correctly, consistently and on time.

Issued in support of Research Innovation Funding Policy, this guide translates the framework into practical steps for implementation. It is intended to be read alongside the principal document and any related circulars.

Scope of Application

Except where expressly stated otherwise, the guidance applies uniformly across Higher Education Department, and institutions should treat it as the reference point for day-to-day decisions on Research.

Covered entities are expected to align their internal procedures with the expectations set out here, adapting them only where local conditions or statutory requirements justify a documented variation.

Eligibility and Preconditions

Prior to implementation, institutions should confirm readiness in respect of Research, Innovation, designate the officers responsible, and document any existing arrangements that will be retained or replaced.

Key Steps

Institutions should first designate accountability, then prepare supporting documentation, brief staff, apply the arrangements and schedule a formal review of the resulting practice.

1. Apply the arrangements and maintain the required records.
2. Report on a regular cycle and act on review findings.
3. Appoint a lead officer and notify Higher Education Department of the designated contact.
4. Conduct an initial readiness review against Research, Innovation.
5. Brief governing bodies, staff and relevant stakeholders on the expectations.

Responsibilities

Higher Education Department coordinates implementation and reviews institutional returns, while institutions manage day-to-day application, maintain records and respond to queries from stakeholders.

Operating Steps

Operational practice must follow an auditable sequence: application or initiation, verification, decision, communication, recording and, where applicable, renewal or extension.

Reporting

Reports should be submitted in the prescribed format and within the stated deadlines, summarising compliance, outcomes, exceptions and any corrective actions taken.

Closing Note

Effective implementation of Research Innovation Funding Policy will depend on sustained institutional commitment and close coordination between Higher Education Department and the sector. Institutions are encouraged to embed the arrangements described here into their normal planning and review cycles.